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ANSWERS : STIMULUS BASED MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The trend depicted in the maps above resulted most directly from which of the following factors?

(A)	Settlers' and miners' desire for better access to land and resources	**Incorrect**: Westward expansion was certainly motivated in part by increasing access to resources but the expansion of railroads did not directly result from this.
(B)	Government subsidies for transportation and communication systems	**Correct**: The private-public partnership between industrialists and the federal government was the driving force behind railroad expansion during and following the American Civil War.
(C)	The violation of government treaties with Native Americans	**Incorrect**: Violations of land treaties definitely contributed to the occasion for further expansion of railroads but did not directly result from it.
(D)	The invention of the steam locomotive and improved steel production	**Incorrect**: The first steam locomotive was invented in the early 19th Century.

2. Which of the following was not an effect of the trend depicted in the maps above?

(A)	Competition for land led to conflict between white settlers and Native Americans	**Incorrect**: The expansion of railroads significantly increased white settlement of the West.
(B)	The bison population in the Great Plains was decimated	**Incorrect**: Railroad companies and the government hired thousands of men to clear their routes of bison herds.
(C)	Increased contributions by immigrant labor led to a sharp decline in nativism	**Correct**: While the Asian and European immigrant contributions to industrial steel production, mining, and laying of railways were significant, nativism actually rose as a result of increased competition for jobs.

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(D)	More efficient transportation led to a decline in food prices	**Incorrect**: Food prices did indeed drop as transportation capacity increased and costs decreased.

3. The change depicted in the maps best explains the

(A)	development of economic differences between regional economies	**Incorrect**: Industrial versus agricultural economies are not directly indicated in the maps. The reach of industrialization, however, affected all regions.
(B)	increased diversity of the industrial workforce due to internal and international migration	**Incorrect**: Internal migration and immigration are not addressed in the maps.
(C)	improved standard of living in the United States following the Civil War	**Incorrect**: Standard of living for Americans is not addressed in the maps.
(D)	growth of the national economy and increasing involvement in global trade	**Correct**: The expansion of railways into the Midwest and West, eventually connecting the East and West Coasts, indicates a larger and interconnected national economy as well better access to foreign markets.

4. Which of the following developments in the second half of the 19th Century most contradicted the goals of the so-called "New South"?

(A)	The election of numerous black men into state and federal government offices	**Incorrect**: While proponents of Grady's vision were predominantly white, the reference to "a perfect democracy" and "closely knitted" society could imply that blacks would enjoy their newly-affirmed equal status in the South.

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(B) The reliance on sharecropping as a social and economic system	**Correct**: Grady envisioned a diverse economy consisting of industrial production and egalitarian agriculture. A newfound reliance on sharecropping, however, maintained an oppressive system of tenant farming with land and profit concentrated in the hands of wealthy, white landowners.
(C) The improvement of industrial infrastructure and production	**Incorrect**: Grady explicitly describes this as a goal of the New South.
(D) The enforcement of segregation following Supreme Court rulings	**Incorrect**: While his vision he does not directly address Plessy v. Ferguson and the issue of segregation, the true nature of the New South was to reaffirm white control of property and wealth through a diversified economy.

5. Which of the following best describes the result of the ideas expressed in the excerpt?

(A) Southern Democrats came to dominate the federal government	**Incorrect**: Throughout the Gilded Age, the Republican Party maintained a firm grip on the presidency.
(B) The South's economic output surpassed that of the North	**Incorrect**: Northern and Midwestern industry continued to dominate the national economy by virtue of population, transportation, and mineral resources.
(C) Northern blacks began moving back to the south	**Incorrect**: The Great Migration referred exclusively to the exodus of blacks from the South to northern and western locales.
(D) Resentment led to the "Lost Cause" when the South did not bounce back	**Correct**: The late 19th Century saw a white Southern effort to revise the history of the Civil War and its causes, remembering it as an honorable conflict with glorified motives.

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6. The cartoon most directly reflects

(A) women's lack of political power in the 19th Century	**Incorrect**: While women did lack political and economic influence without the vote, the focus of the cartoon is on the influence of industrial capitalists.
(B) the growing power of urban political machines in the North	**Incorrect**: Political machines are not directly depicted in the cartoon, despite their strong connections with corporations and monopolists at the time.
(C) the divisiveness of party politics following the Civil War	**Incorrect**: Partisanship is not addressed in the cartoon.
(D) the increased political influence of corporations and special interests	**Correct**: The "titans" or "captains of industry," "robber barons," and "fat cats," of the economic world leveraged their wealth in the political arena to gain favorable legislation.

7. Which of the following did <u>not</u> represent a challenge to the ideas expressed in the cartoon?

(A) Social Gospel	**Incorrect**: Social Gospel saw capitalism as the driving force behind urban poverty and class inequalities.
(B) horizontal integration	**Correct**: Horizontal integration was an economic strategy of merging competition into one corporate entity, which often led to the creation of monopolies.
(C) People's (Populist) Party	**Incorrect**: The Populist Party appealed to workers and farmers, calling for regulations of trusts.
(D) unionization	**Incorrect**: Labor unions' priority was advocating for the rights of workers in the face of increasing mistreatment and low wages issued by corporations.

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8. The reference to "imported pauperized labor" most likely refers to the influence of which historical development in the late 19th Century?

(A) Workforce competition created by an influx of largely poor, uneducated immigrants	**Correct**: Certainly nativist in tone, labor unions saw immigration as a threat to American workers' well-being. In 1890, Ellis Island was designated as a federal immigration station where millions of European immigrants would arrive over the next half century.
(B) American markets being flooded by foreign goods from Asia and Latin America	**Incorrect**: Foreign goods do not fit the description of labor in the excerpt, nor did they begin to dominate American commercial markets for another century.
(C) Migration of formerly enslaved blacks to northern cities following the Civil War	**Incorrect**: The Great Migration would take place in the coming years, especially after the Plessy v. Ferguson case, and did indeed concern urban labor interests. However, as Americans, black migrants could not be considered "imported".
(D) Industrial capitalists cutting wages and subsequently increasing their own profits	**Incorrect**:

9. Which of the following people or groups would have most strongly opposed the ideas expressed in the excerpt above?

(A) The People's (Populist) Party	**Incorrect**: The Populists enjoyed an almost exclusively labor and agricultural constituency. The passage above is actually an excerpt from the founding convention for the People's Party.
(B) factory workers	**Incorrect**: The overwhelming majority of factory workers would have supported the platform laid out in the excerpt as the industrial union interests were discussed.

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(C) Social Darwinists	**Correct**: Social Darwinists would have likely opposed the Farmers' Alliance and union efforts of Populists. Calls for regulations and progressive reforms were intended to "level the playing field" while Social Darwinists saw "survival of the fittest" as valid.
(D) Jane Addams	**Incorrect**: Jane Addams was the celebrated founder of Hull House, a settlement house in Chicago, and was a vocal critic of corporate corruption and mistreatment of workers.

10. Which of the following developments most significantly contributed to the circumstances described in the excerpt above?

(A) The expansion of laissez-faire policies	**Correct**: Laissez-faire policies entailed the lack of regulations and general "hands off" approach by the government toward the national economy. This opened the door for the rampant corruption and abuse of labor that the Populists railed against.
(B) The restriction of immigration from Asia	**Inorrect**: The denial of Chinese immigration in the 1880s only bolstered labor demands at the time and did not further contribute to further economic inequality.
(C) The industrialized North's victory in the Civil War	**Incorrect**: While the Union victory did create the occasion for continued industrial growth, it did not directly lead to corruption and other labor concerns.
(D) The emergence of tenant farming in the South	**Incorrect**: The predominant concerns from a farmer's perspective were the inequitable shipping rates levied by railroad companies. This was an industrial vs agricultural issue rather than the property and racial issue that sharecropping was.

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